

Lesson 3: Learning To Macromanage

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Okay, so if we're all acting like owners, some things need to change, right? You need to be involved in every detail, every decision. Nothing is too small or too large to escape your notice. Be careful, my friend, you are on a slippery slope to micromanagement. Just saying the word causes most team members to cringe.

Did you know there's a way to take ownership without micromanaging? It's called macromanaging, and the best leaders learn how to do it well. As a leader, Coach Summit realized she couldn't be everywhere. It's impossible. And yet the buck stopped with her for the well-being and safety of nearly a dozen young, inexperienced athletes, many of whom were only vaguely familiar with discipline and some of whom had never been away from home before. It was physically impossible to stand over them at all times. This is where instilling a sense of responsibility and ownership in your team and knowing when to back off comes in handy.

You may not be leading athletes like Pat. You're leading employees, but the same principle still applies. If you rush into every situation to help dot every I, cross every T, and help get the ox out of the ditch, will employees learn the buck stops with them or with you?

So, what are some examples of micromanaging versus macromanaging?

Micromanaging might look something like:

- Approving every email before it is sent.
- Frequently redoing employees' work instead of providing feedback.
- Dictating the exact method for completing a task or giving overly detailed instructions for simple tasks.
- Requiring excessive approval for small expenses.
- Requiring employees to track their daily activities in minute detail.
- You know the signs. Likely you've seen this before.

By contrast, macromanaging might look something like:

- Setting clear overall goals and letting employees determine the best way to achieve them.
- Holding periodic check-ins rather than constant monitoring.

- Encouraging autonomy and decision-making for projects someone is owning
- Evaluating employees based on results and outcomes, not time spent on an activity or doing an activity a certain way.

Take a minute to stop and think where you fall on the scale of micromanagement versus macromanagement.

So how do you take the mantle of authority as a leader while also empowering your team to be mini-owners and experts in their craft? We'll take a closer look in this lesson.